

25 per cent of global milk production. Milk production reached to 247.87 million tonnes in 2024–25, from 146.31 million tonnes in 2014–15, an increase of nearly 70%.

Post-independence dairying has been integral to India's growth story with the Government playing a crucial role in harnessing the livestock sector's potential for economic growth, food security, and rural prosperity. It has proved to be the most effective tool for development of rural areas and for socio-economic empowerment of Crores of Dairy Farmers. Over the last 7 decades, initiatives through the National Dairy Development Board (NDDB) under the enabling policy environment provided by the GoI have ensured that the dairy sector has grown by many folds, placing India at the top position in world milk production. The dairy cooperative movement has transformed the entire dairy sector covering all major value chains related to milk and dairy animals.

Dr Meenesh Shah, Chairman, National Dairy Development Board said, "Today, India is 'Aatmanirbhar' in milk production, thanks to the sustained and systematic application of scientific and technological innovations, supported by both the Central and State Governments. With continued momentum and strategic interventions, India is on track to become the 'Dairy to the World'- a global leader in dairy excellence, sustainability and cooperative-driven growth."

PATH BREAKING INITIATIVES- PRODUCTIVITY ENHANCEMENT

The dairy sector of India has witnessed a transformative growth over the past decade, with milk production peaking at 247.87 MT, a remarkable increase of 69.4% in the 11-year period. This surge has been propelled by a 36.63 %productivity rise, highest in the world, increasing to 2251 kg/ animal/ year in 2024-25 from 1,648.17 kg/ animal/ year in 2013-14.



NATIONAL DAIRY PLAN-I

World Bank funded Central Sector Scheme of GoI with a project outlay of Rs. 2,242 Crore namely, National Dairy Plan Phase I (NDP-I) was launched in April 2012. NDP I was implemented by NDDB from 2011-12 to 2018-19 across 18 major dairying States with an outlay of about Rs 2,250 Crores. The project aimed to increase milk production, improve productivity, and provide rural milk producers with access to the organised milk processing sector.

Key achievements included making 2456 High Genetic Merit Bulls available, producing 119 million disease-free semen doses, and improving conception rates from 35% to 44% in the project area.

The project covered 2.87 million milch animals under the Ration Balancing Programme, reduced feeding costs by 12%, and increased milk producers' daily income by about Rs 8,000 per lactation. It also promoted fodder development, constructed 120 biomass bunkers, and provided market access to 1.69 million milk producers. Additionally, NDP I empowered women, with 0.77 million women members enrolled in village-level dairy cooperatives, and contributed to social inclusion and reduced distress migration. By the end of the project during the year 2020-21, India's milk production stood at 210 million tonnes, thus meeting projections. With an economic rate of return of 60%, the World Bank rated NDP I as "Highly Satisfactory".

INITIATIVES UNDERTAKEN UNDER RASHTRIYA GOKUL MISSION

As GoI initiative, Nationwide Artificial Insemination programme implemented in 623 districts with less than 50% AI coverage and 126 districts out of 623 districts brought above 50% AI coverage. With this, AI coverage in the country increased from 25% of the breedable bovine females to 40% of the breedable bovine females.

A technology that ensures the birth of female calves not only reduces the financial burden on dairy farmers by eliminating the need to care for male calves but also offers the potential to produce more replacement heifers from the best cows. In India, there was a need for a cost-effective sex-sorting technology that can boost the income of dairy farmers. However, the available technologies were owned by a few multinational corporations, making the products unaffordable for the average farmer. In line with the 'Make in India' and 'Atmanirbhar